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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

INDEX SHEET SET, LOOSE-LEAF BINDER

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers index sheet sets for all types of loose-leaf binders.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Grades. Index sheet sets shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.2).

Grade A - heavy weight, 95 pound
Grade B - standard weight, 64 pound
Class 1 - coated tabs
Class 2 - uncoated tabs

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood-Cleated, Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Staying Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Port Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Standards:

T 402 - Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets and Related Products.
T 403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T 410 - Weight per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T 411 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard.
T 414 - Internal Tearing Resistance of Paper.
T 435 - Hydrogen Ion Concentration (pH) of Paper Extracts - Hot Extraction Method.
T 511 - Folding Endurance of Paper (MIT Tester).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent,, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036).

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Index sheet sets shall be made from fibrous, cellulosic material and may include reclaimed fibers.

3.2 Physical requirements. The physical characteristics of the index sheet sets shall conform to the requirements of Table I.

Table I. Physical requirements

Characteristic	Grade A	Grade B
Basis weight, 17 x 22-1000	95 pounds ± 5 percent	64 pounds ± 3 percent
Burst, average not less than	110 Pounds per square inch (psi)	
Tear, average not less than	MD 140 grams CD 210 grams	
Thickness	0.0072 inch ±0.0005 inch	
Acidity, pH, not less than	4.6	
Folding endurance (MIT), not less than		40 folds

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3.3 Construction. The binding edge of the index sheet shall be reinforced with either the same stock as the index paper or polymeric material around each hole. Reinforcing may also be accomplished by a strip on one or both sides extending the full length of the sheet on the binding side. The reinforcing strip shall be 9/16, plus or minus 1/16 inch wide.

3.3.1 Corners. The corners of the index sheet shall be rounded or square as specified (see 6.2).

3.3.2 Holes. The holes for size 3 x 5 inches shall be 3/16 inch ± 1/32 inch in diameter. The holes shall be 3/16 inch from the edge of the sheet to the centers of the holes with a tolerance of 1/32 inch. All other sizes of index sheets shall have holes 1/4 inch ± 1/16 inch in diameter, and these holes shall be 3/8 inch from the edge of the sheet to the centers of the holes with a tolerance of ± 1/32 inch. The top and bottom hole of all sheet sizes shall be located equidistant from top and bottom edge of the sheet. The spacing between the holes for each size shall be as stated in table II.

3.4 Sizes.

3.4.1 Standard sizes. Index sheets, exclusive of tabs, shall be the sizes stated in table II. The binding side shall be cited first.

Table II. Sheet sizes and hole spacing

Size of sheet, inches tolerance ± 1/32 inch	Number of holes	Spacing between holes, center to center, inches, tolerance ± 1/16 in.
3 x 5	3	3/4
7-1/4 x 4-1/4	3	2-3/4
8-1/2 x 11	3	2-3/4
9-1/2 x 6	3	3-1/2
11 x 8-1/2	3	4-1/2
10-1/2 x 8	3	4-1/2

3.4.2 Special sizes. Index sheets, not covered in 3.4.1 shall be trimmed as specified in 3.3.1 for use with sheets of the size specified in the contract or order. In all other respects the sheets shall comply with the requirements of this specification (see 6.2).

3.5 Tabs.

3.5.1 Grades A and B. Grades A and B index sheet sets shall be furnished with self tabs.

3.5.1.1 Height and length. Height of the tabs shall be commercial standard for sheet size (1/4, 3/8, and 1/2 inch), a plus or minus tolerance of 1/16 inch will be allowed. Length of tabs (up and down leaf) shall be as specified in contract or order.

3.5.1.2 Corners. The top corners of the self tabs shall be rounded or square as specified (see 6.2).

3.5.1.3 Spacing. Tabs shall be positioned as specified in contract or order by number of tabs once through on the length of leaf or in special position (see 6.2).

3.5.1.4 Reinforcing. The entire surface of the self tabs of grade A and grade B, class 1, shall be coated, laminated or heat-sealed on each side by a polymeric material. This material shall extend onto the index sheet on each side not less than 3/8 inch and extend over each end of the tab edge on the index sheet not less than 3/8 inch. The tabs of grade B, class 2 shall not be reinforced.

3.5.1.5 Color. The tabs of grade A index sheet sets shall be furnished clear, amber, blue, green, orange, red and yellow, as specified (see 6.2). The tabs of grade B, class 1 index sheet sets shall be furnished clear.

3.5.1.6 Printing. Index sheet tabs shall be printed as specified (see 6.2) also specially lettered when sample is furnished with contract or order.

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3.6 Workmanship. Index sheet paper and tabs shall be free from any defects which may effect serviceability, and shall be of good formation, clean, free from spots, wrinkles, folds, holes, tears, and other imperfections. Paper and tabs shall be smoothly cut without nicks or ragged edges. Tabs shall be free from cracking and peeling under normal conditions of usage.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Sampling for examination and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise noted. For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of index sheet sets of one grade and size submitted for inspection at one time.

4.1.2 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications and standards.

4.2.2 Inspection of the end item.

4.2.2.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined in accordance with the classification of defects and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) set forth in 4.2.2.1.5. The lot size for purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105 shall be expressed in units of index sheet sets offered for delivery at one time for examination in 4.2.2.1.1 and 4.2.2.1.2, in units of packaged index sheet ssets for examination in 4.2.2.1.3, and in units of shipping containers for examination in 4.2.2.1.4.

4.2.2.1.1 Visual examination of the end item. A visual examination of the end item shall be conducted in accordance with the classification of defects set forth herein. The sample unit for this examination shall be one index sheet set. Index sheets in sample index sets shall be examined for the defects listed below.

Examine	Defect
Index sets	Color not uniform.
Finish and cleanliness	Surface not smooth. Surface dirty.
Construction	Binding edge not reinforced; or not reinforced as ordered. Punching missing or improperly spaced. Corners not as specified.
Tabs	Missing. Not color tab ordered. Not tab ordered. Corners not as specified. Wrong spacing. Printing incorrect; not sharp and uniform, when applicable.
Workmanship	Edges of index set sheets ragged, crushed, or broken. Welted, cockled, wrinkled, creased, or curled sheets. Scuffs, slime holes.

4.2.2.1.2 Examination of the end item for defects in dimensions. The sample unit for this examination shall be one index sheet.

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Examine	Defects
Size	Not within allowable tolerance.
Binding edge reinforcement	Not 9/16 ± 1/16 inch wide.
Tabs (height and width)	Not size ordered within tolerance.

4.2.2.1.3 Examination of the end item for average count per package. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box or package of index sheet sets. The average count per package of all sample units examined shall be not less than the specified or indicated quantity.

Examine	Defect
Count	Number of sheets per package more or less than specified.

4.2.2.1.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery.

Examine	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Contents	Not as specified.
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Cushioning inadequate, improper or missing.

4.2.2.1.4.1 Examination of closure of containers. When shipping containers are required to comply with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of that specification.

4.2.2.1.5 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) for examinations. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) expressed in defects per 100 units, shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL
For examination in 4.2.2.1.1	S-4	2.5
For examination in 4.2.2.1.2	S-2	4.0
For examination in 4.2.2.1.3	S-2	---
For examination in 4.2.2.1.4	S-3	4.0

4.2.3 Testing of end item. The index sheets and tabs shall be tested for the paper characteristics listed in table III. All tests shall be performed under TAPPI method T 402. The sample unit shall be 10 consecutive index sheets. The sample size shall be the number of sample units to be taken as representative of the lot size. The lot size shall be the number of index sheet sets submitted for acceptance at one time. The sample size shall be determined in accordance with inspection level S-1, MIL-STD-105, except that not less than two sample units will be taken. There shall be no failure to meet the lot average requirements.

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Table III. Testing of the end item

Characteristic	Specification Reference: Requirement	Specification Reference: Test Method	Results Applicable to: Sample Unit	Results Applicable to: Lot Av.	Number determinations per sample unit	Results Expressed as: Pass or Fail	Results Expressed as: Numerically to nearest
Atmospheric conditions	4.2.3	T 402	All testing				
Basis weight	Table I	T 410		Y	10		1 pound
Burst	Table I	T 403		X	10		1 psi
Tear	Table I	T 414		X	10 each direction		1 gram
Thickness	Table I	T 411		X	10		0.0001 inch
Acidity	Table I	T 435		X	2 or composite 1/		0.1 pH
Folding endurance	Table I	T 511		X	10 each direction		1 fold

1/ The composite sample shall consist of approximately equal amounts drawn from all the sample units into a single sample.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Level A. The number of sheets specified in the invitation for bid or purchase order shall be packaged in paperboard folding or setup boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676, style optional. The arrangement of the sheets within the boxes shall be alternate placement for each 25 or 50 sheets top to bottom with tabs positioned in sequence.

5.1.2 Level B. Each index set or 20 sets of 1/5 cut components shall be secured with one of the following: a band of paper, a sealed transparent bag or a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2.1 Intermediate packaging. Five packaged sets of 1/5 cut components or twelve packaged index sets shall be intermediately packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.3 Level C. Each index set shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving agency.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Exterior shipping containers shall conform to overseas type boxes conforming to any of the following specifications:

PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound (class 3).
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard, (class 2 V3s or V3c, style RSC).

The net weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 75 pounds. Closures shall be in accordance with the applicable box specification and the appendix thereto. Each shipping container shall be provided with a type I or II, grade B or C, class 2 case liner, conforming to MIL-L-10547. Only one type, size, and style of shipping container shall be used for any one item on any one contact.

5.2.2 Level B. Nine, ten, twelve, or fifteen, as specified (see 6.2) intermediate packages shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic.

5.2.3 Level C. Index sets in quantities as specified (see 6.2), packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in containers to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

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5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required in the procurement documents, marking of the interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 for civil agencies of MIL-STD-129 for military agencies, as applicable (see 6.2).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Grade A index sheet sets purchased under this specification are intended to be used with all types of loose-leaf binders. Each tab of the same or different colors and printing, is used for a special caption to index topical subject matter contained in identification, technical and performance manuals and handbooks, covering regulations, instructions, etc., such as hospital charts, submarine and aircraft instructions. These index sheet sets are not to be used for general purposes such as numerical or alphabetical indexing, listing in the Stores Stock Catalog, or stocking depots. Each order represents a particular requirement having a specialized use.

Grade B index sheet sets are to be used for general purpose such as numerical or alphabetical indexing, and shall be listed in the Stock Catalog and stocked in depots.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 3.4.1 and 3.4.2).
(c) Corners and punching required (see 3.3.1 and 3.3.2)
(d) Tabs (see 3.5.1.1, 3.5.1.2, 3.5.1.3, and 3.5.1.5).
(e) Printing (see 3.5.1.6).
(f) Levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) Marking document required (see 5.3).

6.3 The Department of Defense waives coordination of this specification.

MILITARY INTEREST

Army-GL

Preparing Activity

GSA-FSS

Civil Agencies Coordinating Activity

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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